ACCESSIBLE DESIGN

TIPS FOR CONTENT DEVELOPERS (COPYWRITERS)

Be Accessible®

What is accessible web design?

Accessible web design provides a website that all users can navigate, understand, and interact with regardless of their abilities.

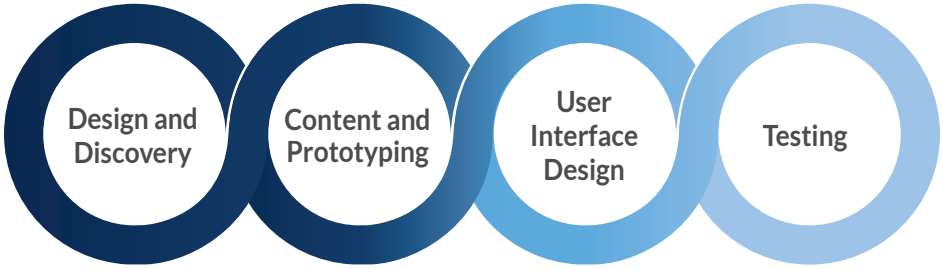
According to the **W**eb **C**ontent **A**ccessibility **G**uidelines (WCAG) provided by the **W**orld **W**ide **W**eb **C**onsortium (W3C), an accessible website is perceivable, operable, understandable, and robust.

Who is responsible for creating accessible websites?

Each designer has an important role during development to ensure accessible results. Working together, designers ensure web content is accessible to people with a variety of abilities.

The tables on the following pages define what each designer is responsible for providing, when they should be included in the development process, and how their expertise impacts accessibility.

Example of a four-stage development process:



How do I use WCAG?

Web accessibility testing involves an extensive step-by-step process of manual evaluation and is best achieved during the development phase of a website.

WCAG's four principles include testable success criteria that are divided into three levels of conformance: Level A, Level AA, and Level AAA. Each level is defined based on a set of success criteria.

You can find WCAG online at https://www.w3.org/TR/WCAG21/

Is WCAG Enough?

Although WCAG is extensive, real users testing is required to confirm a website's accessibility. Include disabled users in your web accessibility testing process.

If your development team needs accessibility training, contact Be Accessible. We will provide the guidance needed to ensure your website is accessible to everyone.

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Content Developers

Accessible code development begins with accessible content development. Content developers (copywriters) notably influence a website's accessibility. They provide accessible web content by using clear language, a well-organized page structure, and an understandable workflow.

DO	DON'T	WHY
Use headings to organize content	Write long blocks of text without structure	Heading structure allows content skimming.
DOWNLOAD GUIDE Use descriptive link text	DOWNLOAD HERE Use generic link text	Descriptive link text reduces confusion
alt="dalmatian puppy" Provide meaningful <alt> text	alt="cat" Use inaccurate descriptions or captions	Accurate <alt> text allows all users to receive the same content
Include captions and/or transcripts for video and audio content	Exclude video/audio captions	Users with auditory disabilities rely on captions to access content.
Username Password Incorrect Provide informative error messages	Username Exclude error messages	Users with cognitive, language, and learning disabilities will enter information correctly.